



On guard

Propped up by their tails, adult meerkats take turns standing and watching out for predators, while the rest of their pack relaxes or plays. Eagles and hawks pose the biggest danger. If a sentry spots a predator, it barks a specific alarm call, and the meerkats quickly disappear into their burrows.

Walking on water

Kicking out with its large, hind feet, a sailfin lizard splashes its way to safety by sprinting across the surface of a stream. This escape technique works best in early life. Young lizards can race over water for short distances of about 16 ft (5 m) because their bodies are small and light.

Slower-moving adults soon start to sink and have to switch to swimming instead.

Foot kicks backward



Follow me

Plovers nest on the ground, where there is danger all around. If a predator approaches its nest, the parent bird stages a distraction display to protect its chicks. The plover pretends to have a broken wing and flutters away from the nest, luring the predator off course. Once the predator has moved to a safe distance, the plover flies back to its young.

Losing limbs

In emergencies, many animals can shed arms, legs, or tails, which helps them flee to safety. For some animals, the loss is permanent, but often the missing body part gradually grows back.



New claw

Claw

A lobster's lost claw will slowly regrow, getting bigger each time the crustacean sheds, or molts, its shell.



Tail fracture line

Tail

The tail of the alligator lizard breaks off easily, leaving a stump. A new tail regrows, but contains cartilage instead of bone.

Original arm

Regenerating arm



Arm

Starfish that lose arms to a predator are able to grow, or regenerate, new ones in their place. Here, an arm that has broken off is turning into a whole new starfish.